

updated: October 2026

Juan Pablo Atal

602 PCPSE, 133 South 36th St
Philadelphia, PA, 19104
ataljp@econ.upenn.edu

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

- 2026–Present: Associate Professor of Economics, University of Pennsylvania, Department of Economics
- 2017–2026: Assistant Professor of Economics, University of Pennsylvania, Department of Economics
- 2025–2026: Associate Undergraduate Chair, University of Pennsylvania, Department of Economics
- 2024–2025: Interim Associate Undergraduate Chair, University of Pennsylvania, Department of Economics
- 2016–2023: Associate Undergraduate Chair, University of Pennsylvania, Department of Economics
- 2016: Lecturer in Economics, University of Pennsylvania, Department of Economics

AFFILIATIONS

- 2024–Present: Faculty Research Fellow, National Bureau of Economic Research
- 2018–Present: Richard Axilrod Faculty Fellow
- 2017–Present: Research Associate, Graduate Group in Demography, University of Pennsylvania
- 2017–Present: Research Associate, Population Studies Center, University of Pennsylvania
- 2016–Present: Senior Fellow, Leonard Davis Institute for Health Economics, University of Pennsylvania

EDUCATION

- University of California, Berkeley, Ph.D., Economics, 2016
- Universidad de Chile, M.Sc., Economics, 2008
- Universidad de Chile, B.Sc., Industrial Engineering, 2008

PUBLICATIONS AND RESEARCH

Published and Accepted Papers

- Atal, J.P., Cuesta, J. and Sæthre, M., 2025. Quality Regulation and Competition: Evidence from Pharmaceutical Markets. *PIER Working Paper 19-017*. Accepted at the *Review of Economic Studies*
- Atal, J.P., Fang, H., Karlsson, M. and Ziebarth, N.R., 2025. German Long-Term Health Insurance: Theory Meets Evidence. *Journal of Political Economy*, 133(6), pp. 1840–1885
- Allende, C., Atal, J.P., Carril, R., Cuesta, J.I. and Gonzalez-Lira, A., 2024. Drivers of Public Procurement prices: Evidence from Pharmaceutical Markets. *International Journal of Industrial Organization*, 96, 103086
- Atal, J.P., Cuesta, J.I., Gonzalez, F. and Otero, C., 2024. The Economics of the Public Option: Evidence from Local Pharmaceutical Markets. *American Economic Review*, 114(3), pp. 615–644
- Alé-Chilet, J. and Atal, J.P., 2020. Countervailing Market Power and Consumer Surplus: An Empirical Examination. In *AEA Papers and Proceedings* (Vol. 110, pp. 579–583). American Economic Association

- Alé-Chilet, J. and Atal, J.P., 2020. Trade Associations and Collusion among Many Agents: Evidence from Physicians. *The RAND Journal of Economics*, 51(4), pp. 1197–1221
- Alé-Chilet, J., Atal, J.P. and Domínguez, P., 2020. Where are the Missing Emergencies? Lockdown and Health Risk During the Pandemic. *Covid Economics*, Issue 14, 6 May 2020, pp. 57–84
- Atal, J.P., Fang, H., Karlsson, M. and Ziebarth, N.R., 2019. Exit, Voice, or Loyalty? An Investigation Into Mandated Portability of Front-Loaded Private Health Plans. *Journal of Risk and Insurance*, 86(3), pp. 697–727
- Brown, T.T. and Atal, J.P., 2019. How Robust are Reference Pricing Studies on Outpatient Medical Procedures? Three Different Preprocessing Techniques Applied to Difference-in-Differences. *Health Economics*, 28(2), pp. 280–298

Working Papers

- Trachtman, H., Friedman-Soluker, N, Atal, J.P., and Alé-Chilet, J. 2026. Treating Surgeons: Evidence from a Field Experiment on Cost Containment, *Revision Requested at the Journal of the European Economic Association*.
- Alé-Chilet, J., Atal, J.P., Benítez, A. and González-Cabello, M., 2026. The Impact of Information Systems in High-Stakes Decisions: Evidence from Physicians. *mimeo*
- Atal, J.P., Larroucau, T., Muñoz, P. and Otero, C., 2025. Physician’s Occupational Licensing and the Quantity-Quality Trade-off, *PIER Working Paper 25-016*.
- Alé-Chilet, J., Atal, J.P. and Domínguez, P., 2020. Social and Economic Activity Predicts Daily Hospital Emergency Visits. *mimeo*
- Atal, J.P., 2019. Lock-in in Dynamic Health Insurance Contracts: Evidence from Chile. *PIER Working Paper 19-020*

Book Chapters

- Safe and Sound Social Policy: Reconciling Protection with Productivity. In C. Pagés (Ed.), *The Age of Productivity: Transforming Economies from the Bottom Up*, Palgrave Macmillan, 2010, pp. 181–206

GRANTS

- United States-Israel Binational Science Foundation, 2021–2025 (\$ 270,000)
- The Maurice Falk Institute for Economics Research in Israel, 2021–2024 (\$ 14,062)
- University of Pennsylvania Global Engagement Funds, 2021 (\$ 39,273)
- Center for Improving Care Delivery for the Aging (CICADA), 2019 (\$ 30,000) (co-awardee with Sebastian Fleitas)
- Quartet Pilot Project Competition, 2019 (\$ 5000) (co-awardee with Torsten Walter)
- Richard Axilrod Fellowship, 2018 (\$ 50,000)
- Development Bank of Latin America (CAF) Grant, on Health for Social Inclusion in Latin America, 2017 (\$ 15,000) (co-awardee with José Ignacio Cuesta and Morten Sæthre)
- Chilean National Commission for Scientific and Technological Research, 2015–2017 (\$ 58,290) (co-awardee with Claudio Agostini and Andrea Repetto)
- Center for Effective Global Action (CEGA) University of California, Development Economics Research Challenge Grant (\$ 15,286) (co-awardee with Felipe Gonzalez and José Ignacio Cuesta)

AWARDS

- Best Paper, Center for European Economic Research (ZEW), (co-awardee with Hanming Fang, Martin Karlsson and Nicolas Ziebarth), 2025
- Berkeley Competition Center Policy Prize (Best campus-wide dissertation on topics related to competition policy), 2016
- American Society of Health Economists, Student Paper Award (co-awardee with Elena Prager), 2016

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES AND AFFILIATIONS

Referee Activities

American Economic Review, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Economic Journal: Microeconomics, American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, Canadian Journal of Economics, Econometrica, Economics Letters, Health Economics, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Human Resources, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Political Economy Microeconomics, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Risk and Insurance, Quarterly Journal of Economics, The Journal of Risk Management and Insurance, The RAND Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics

Consulting Activities

- Inter-American Development Bank

Seminar and Conference Presentations

- 2026: Georgetown, Cowles (Labor and Public).
- 2025: TSE Health Conference, SITE, ASHEcon, Georgetown, Development Bank of Latin America (CAF), UNC Chapel Hill, Universidad de Chile, PUC (Chile), ITAM, UNAM
- 2024: Princeton University, Johns Hopkins, Fordham University
- 2023: Columbia University (Health Care Management), Chicago (Harris School of Public Policy), PUC (Chile), FEN (Chile), Universidad de los Andes (Chile), Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez (Chile), ESE Finance Conference (invited speaker, Universidad de los Andes, Chile)
- 2022: NBER Insurance Meeting, ITAM, Barcelona Structural Econometrics, LACEA (Invited IO Session)
- 2021: Universidad Carlos III, Universidad de Chile, Tsinghua University, CEPR IO Meeting, Toulouse School of Economics
- 2020: Universidad de Talca (Chile), Universidad Adolfo Ibáñez (Chile), Latin-American and Caribbean Health Economics Network
- 2019: KU-Leuven, American Society of Health Economists, Latin-American and Caribbean Health Economics Network, NBER Insurance Meeting, Utah Winter Business Economics Conference
- 2018: University of Wisconsin-Madison, American Society of Health Economists, Southern Economic Association
- 2017: Norwegian School of Economics, NYU, Penn (Wharton)
- 2016: Rice, CEMFI (Madrid), INSEAD (Paris), PUC (Chile), CEA (Chile), Penn (Economics)

Membership in Scientific Committees

- Penn Global Engagement Funds
- Research Director, The Research Institute for Development, Growth, and Economics (RIDGE)

- Latin-American and Caribbean Health Economics Network, 2018–2020
- Chilean National Commission for Scientific and Technological Research, 2017, 2018, 2021, 2024

TEACHING ACTIVITIES

Courses Taught (By Subject)

- Graduate Topics in Industrial Organization (Econ 8400)
- Undergraduate Health Economics (Econ 4460)
- Undergraduate Industrial Organization (Econ 4450)

Courses Taught (By Year)

- AY 2025/26, Fall Semester: Econ 4460, Econ 8400; Spring Semester: Econ 8400
- AY 2024/25, Spring Semester: Econ 4460, Econ 8400
- AY 2023/24, Fall Semester: Econ 4450; Spring Semester: Econ 4460, Econ 8400
- AY 2022/23, Spring Semester: Econ 4460, Econ 8400
- AY 2021/22, Spring Semester: Econ 4460, Econ 8400
- AY 2020/21; Fall Semester: Econ 4460
- AY 2018/19, Fall Semester: Econ 4460; Spring Semester: Econ 4460, Econ 8400
- AY 2017/18, Spring Semester: Econ 4460, Econ 8400
- AY 2016/17, Fall Semester: Econ 4460; Spring Semester: Econ 4460

PhD Advising

- Current and Former Third-Year Paper Reader: Siqu Li, Zhemin Yuan, Olivia Gilbert, Michal Hodor, Isaac Rabanni, Shasha Wang, Bradley Smith
- Current and Former Committee Member: Jonathan Arnold, Alejandra Benitez, Bernardo de Moura, Olivia Gilbert, Siqu Li, Keusang Song, Kathleen Hui, Priyanka Goonetilleke, Zhemin Yuan, Eliana Sena, Bradley Smith

SERVICE ACTIVITIES

Department of Economics

- Industrial Organization Workshop Co-Organizer
- Empirical Micro Lunch Seminar Co-Organizer
- Secondary Advisor for Honors Theses

School of Arts and Sciences

- SAS Committee on Undergraduate Education, 2025–
- Humanities and Social Sciences Sector Committee, 2022–2023
- Curriculum Committee, 2021–2022
- Member of Working Group on Diversity, Inequality, and Human Well-Being, 2019

Other

- Steering Committee, Population Studies Center